who had thus far violated the law for the past 42 years, since 1976, freedom from any prosecution or penalty!

Fighting Terrorism and Counterfeit Notes

For several years, there have been concerns regarding the large number of fairly sophisticated counterfeit notes in circulation in India, often referred to as Fake Indian Currency Notes (FICN). Given their sophisticated quality, it is widely believed that these could only have been produced in the printing presses of a hostile nation state.

It is also widely believed that such counterfeit notes have been used to finance illicit activities such as smuggling, narcotics, cross-border arms running, human trafficking and terrorism.[11]

In August 2016, the Minister of State for Finance stated in the Parliament:[12] 'A study on Fake Indian Currency Notes (FICN) issues, including estimation of FICN in circulation, has been undertaken by Indian Statistical Institute (ISI), Kolkata under the overall supervision of National Investigation Agency (NIA). As per the study, the face value of FICN in circulation was found to be about ₹400 crore. It was found the value remained constant for the last four years.'

The study, which was undertaken in 2015, further estimated that fake currency worth ₹70 crore entered circulation every year, with agencies only being able to intercept one-third of this amount. As per the NIA probe, Pakistan was the major supplier of FICN in India. The study concluded, 'The existing systems of seizure and detection are enough to flush out the quantum of FICN being infused.'

A special FICN Coordination (FCORD) Group was formed in the Ministry of Home Affairs to deal with the problem of counterfeit currency in an integrated manner, and to share intelligence and information amongst the different security agencies of State/Centre to counter the menace of circulation of fake currency notes in the country. The NIA was empowered by the NIA Act to investigate and prosecute offences relating to FICN. The government also constituted